

RELOCATION GUIDE

Hobart

nipaluna

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Hobart.

A mountain over the wards. A harbour at the end of the street.

Hobart is Australia's most deliberate capital: a working harbour city folded around the Derwent, with kunanyi / Mount Wellington standing directly above it. It carries the depth of Tasmania's single statewide health service, a university medical school and some of the shortest commutes in the country. People rarely drift here; they choose it, and the clinicians who do are among the happiest we place anywhere.

~250,000

people in Greater Hobart

15 min

from the city to the
mountain road

1,271 m

kunanyi / Mount
Wellington, above the
city

100%

of Tasmania counts as
regional for skilled
migration

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Hobart

Hobart's photographs undersell the practical case: a walkable harbour city, serious medicine, and wilderness twenty minutes from the ward. Here is what it gives a working clinician, and who it suits best.



If you are looking for big-city buzz and a metropolis-sized job market, Hobart may not be it. But if you are drawn to a city you can hold in your head, a health system that knows your name and a mountain at the end of your street, it could be a wonderful choice.

Start with the working life. Tasmania runs its public health care as **one statewide service**, and Hobart carries its depth: the state's principal referral hospital, the island's widest range of specialist services and the university's medical school alongside it. Careers here run broad rather than narrow. You see more, carry more, and are known by name in a way that larger systems rarely manage. Smaller systems also tend to look after the people they recruit, with relocation help, genuine welcomes and rosters negotiated with a human.

Then the life around the work. Housing costs less than in the big mainland capitals, commutes are short from almost every suburb, and the city's real currency is proximity: the mountain fifteen minutes from the wards, the harbour at the end of the street, and World Heritage wilderness an hour or two away. The whole of Tasmania, Hobart included, is classed as regional for skilled migration, which can open extra visa pathways and points.

15 min

wards to the mountain
road

1

statewide public health
service

move around the island
without changing
employer

100%

of Tasmania is regional for
migration

which can open extra visa
pathways

A week here can plausibly hold all of this: a shift that starts without traffic; an after-work walk on kunanyi's foothill tracks or a swim at Kingston Beach in the long summer light; Salamanca Market on Saturday morning, then a cellar-door lunch in the Coal River Valley; and Sunday under the sea cliffs of the Tasman Peninsula, home by dark. In winter the same week simply changes shape: snow on the mountain over

breakfast, a log fire in a pub that has kept one burning for a century, and June given over to the fires and feasts of Dark Mofo. People here don't wait out the seasons; they use them.

WHAT YOU GAIN

Breadth and recognition

A wide case mix, responsibility earlier, and colleagues who know you within weeks.

Time back

Short commutes from almost everywhere, so evenings are yours.

Nature on the doorstep

A mountain, a harbour and some of the world's great wilderness, all within easy reach.

Four real seasons

Autumn colour, crisp blue winter days and long summer evenings: home for anyone who misses proper seasons.

GOOD TO KNOW

A smaller market

One principal referral centre; some narrow sub-specialty work is referred to Melbourne. Worth talking through if you have a very specific career ladder in mind.

Winter is part of the deal

Cool, short days from June to August. Choose a warm, well-heated home and you'll find locals embrace the season with gusto.

Island logistics

Family visits and big shopping trips mean a flight or the ferry; Melbourne is about 75 minutes away by air.

A quick rental market

Good homes go fast, so arrive with your paperwork ready.



Weighing up your options?

If you need scale, such as sub-specialty depth or two big-system careers, Sydney or Melbourne carry more sites. If the dream is warmth rather than wilderness, Brisbane may suit you better. If you're drawn to seasons, nature and a close-knit system, Hobart could be a great choice. We are always happy to talk any of them through.



Salamanca Place: sandstone warehouses, cafés and the Saturday market, with the mountain behind



Autumn colour in a Hobart garden: the seasons really do change here



In a smaller system, colleagues get to know you quickly



Breadth of work and a close team around you



Coffee culture is serious, even in a small city



Weekend brunch: a much-loved Australian ritual



Cool-climate sparkling wine: a cellar-door lunch is never far away

The mountain, the harbour and four real seasons

Hobart reads simply once you have the shape of it: a harbour city folded around the Derwent estuary, a mountain standing directly over it, and two shores linked by one bridge.

kunanyi / Mount Wellington rises straight out of the city to 1,271 metres. Its summit road is about a fifteen-minute drive from the city centre, and locals read the day's weather from the mountain. Below it, Sullivans Cove and the working docks around Constitution Dock and Salamanca Place still land fish and fill restaurants, a rare thing among Australian capitals. Founded in 1804, Hobart is Australia's second-oldest capital after Sydney.

The **Tasman Bridge** is the hinge of the city. The western shore holds the city centre, the university and most of the inner suburbs; the eastern shore (Bellerive, Lindisfarne, Rosny) is about ten minutes over the bridge, with water views and morning sun. South of the centre, Kingston and Blackmans Bay are the family-beach suburbs, and beyond them the Huon Valley opens into orchards and river towns. North up the Derwent, New Town and Glenorchy offer gentler prices.



The summit of kunanyi / Mount Wellington, about fifteen minutes' drive from the city

The climate is cool temperate, with four distinct seasons: closer to England, Ireland or New Zealand's South Island than to mainland Australia. The weather can change quickly in any month, so layers and a good jacket are year-round companions, and the UV is strong even when the air is cool.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Mild and long-lit, with days around 17–23°C and evenings that stay cool. Light until late, and the city's big, bright festival fortnight at New Year.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Still, clear and golden, around 12–18°C. Deciduous trees turn red and gold: many locals' favourite season.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Cool and crisp, around 4–12°C, often with blue skies and snow dusting the summit. Log fires, Dark Mofo and cosy evenings.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Fresh, breezy and green, around 11–17°C, with blossom in the gardens and the days lengthening fast.

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Warm homes: what to look for

Much of Hobart's housing is older and full of character. Ask how a home is heated before you sign: a good heat pump and decent curtains transform winter. And if you'll drive the mountain road on cold mornings, locals will happily share their black-ice habits.

A note on Country



Hobart stands on the Country of the muwinina people, and its palawa kani name is nipaluna. Today's Tasmanian Aboriginal community, the palawa/pakana, carries one of the oldest living cultures on earth.



Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings, and health services work in partnership with Aboriginal community-controlled organisations.



Dual names are official and warmly used: nipaluna (Hobart), kunanyi (Mount Wellington) and kanamaluka (the Tamar). Learning them early is noticed and appreciated.

WORDS YOU'LL HEAR

WHAT THEY MEAN

nipaluna

Hobart, in palawa kani

kunanyi

Mount Wellington: "the mountain"

Salamanca

The sandstone waterfront row, and its Saturday market

MONA

The Museum of Old and New Art, reached by ferry

WORDS YOU'LL HEAR	WHAT THEY MEAN
The Spirit	The Spirit of Tasmania car ferry across Bass Strait
The mainland	Everywhere else in Australia, said with affection



Launceston, the island's second city, about two and a half hours north of Hobart



Early starts and big views: outdoor weekends in every season



Layers, a camp stove and a flask: dressing for changeable weather

Healthcare and work in Hobart

Registration is national and hiring across Tasmania is statewide. Hobart's distinguishing feature is depth: it carries the principal referral hospital for the whole island and the widest range of roles in the state.

Tasmania runs public health care as **one statewide service** rather than splitting the island into separate networks. Hobart's principal hospital holds the state's specialist and tertiary services, including cardiothoracic surgery, neurosurgery and burns, and the university's medical school shares the city with it, alongside nursing and allied health teaching. Private and not-for-profit hospitals sit alongside the public system, and Aboriginal community-controlled health organisations work in partnership across it.

Because it is one employer across the island, a move between Hobart, the north and the north-west is an internal move rather than a new job. Seniority and relationships carry with you, and many clinicians build a career across two of the three regions.



Breadth is the hallmark of a Hobart career: a varied case mix and responsibility early

1

statewide public health service

one employer across the island

3

regions to build a career across

Hobart, the north and the north-west

~75 min

flight to Melbourne

for the few sub-specialty referrals

PRINCIPAL REFERRAL CENTRE

Hobart: the depth

The state's specialist and tertiary services, with the medical school beside them, and the widest range of roles in Tasmania.

TEACHING HOSPITAL · LAUNCESTON

The north

A substantial regional service with its own teaching presence and a broad generalist caseload; a common route in.

MOST GENERALIST

The north-west

Where scope is widest, incentives for hard-to-fill posts are most likely, and housing costs least.

TEACHING & RESEARCH

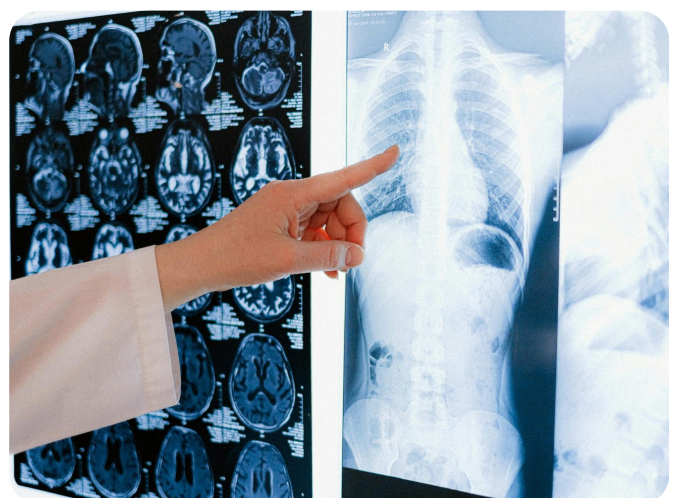
A university on the doorstep

Joint clinical and academic roles are more available than the city's size suggests.

What a smaller system means for a career is, above all, breadth. Hobart clinicians see a wider case mix and carry more responsibility earlier than many big-city colleagues; generalist skills are prized, and the referral role for the whole island keeps the caseload varied. Some narrow sub-specialty work is referred to Melbourne, so if you have a very specific career ladder in mind, it is worth talking it through with us. In a system this size you are known quickly, and services tend to look after the people they go to the trouble of recruiting from overseas.



Continuity of care is easier to see in a smaller, close-knit system



Imaging and allied health roles carry real breadth in Hobart

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Salary packaging: public health roles can package part of your pay before tax. Ask how much, and how to start it from day one.
- ☐ The roster: shift patterns, penalty rates, on-call frequency, and how gaps are covered in a smaller team.
- ☐ Scope and supervision: what you'll carry, and the support around it, especially in your first year.
- ☐ CPD: funded time and money, and whether mainland conference travel is covered.
- ☐ Public, private or both: what rights of private practice exist in your profession.
- ☐ Where you'll work: which site, and parking at your shift times.
- ☐ Professional indemnity: what the employer covers and what you hold yourself.



Two things to do early

Start your Ahpra registration as soon as Hobart is on your shortlist: in a smaller system, start dates move at the speed of paperwork. And check ambulance cover on arrival: Tasmanian residents generally don't pay for ambulances, but many temporary visa holders aren't covered by that waiver, so make sure your health insurance includes it.

Where to live in Hobart

On an island where nothing is far from anything, this choice is less about commute and more about which Hobart you want: the harbour village, the eastern shore, the beach south or the valley.

~5–10 MIN · HARBOUR & HERITAGE

Battery Point & Sandy Bay

Georgian cottages, yacht clubs, the university and the waterfront on foot. The postcard, at postcard prices.

~5–10 MIN · MOUNTAIN VIEWS

West Hobart & South Hobart

Weatherboard character on the slopes of kunanyi, a walk to town and bush tracks from the back gate.

~5–10 MIN · VILLAGE HIGH STREETS

North Hobart & New Town

The city's best eating strip in North Hobart, and New Town's own shops and gentler prices just beyond.

~10 MIN · BELLERIVE, LINDISFARNE, ROSNY

The eastern shore

Water views, morning sun and noticeably better value, across the Tasman Bridge. The first trade-off many locals make.

~20 MIN · BEACHES

Kingston & Blackmans Bay

The family-beach suburbs to the south, with surf lifesaving clubs, newer homes and good schools.

~15–20 MIN · VALUE

Glenorchy & the northern suburbs

The most affordable corridor still in the city, with its own shopping and services, a large Filipino and multicultural community, and the Derwent cycleway into town.

~30–45 MIN · ORCHARDS & ACREAGE

The Huon Valley

Huonville, Franklin and Cygnet: orchards, artists, river mist and a wood fire. Loved by clinicians who want land.



Hillside homes of brick and weatherboard: inner Hobart's character housing

IF YOU WANT...	CONSIDER	BECAUSE
To walk to work and the waterfront	Battery Point, Sandy Bay, West Hobart	Minutes from the principal hospital and the city
Water views on a budget	The eastern shore	Ten minutes over the bridge, with morning sun
Beach family life	Kingston & Blackmans Bay	Surf clubs and newer homes, about 20 minutes south
Acreage and orchards	The Huon Valley	River-valley life, 30–45 minutes out
Value, still in the city	New Town & Glenorchy	Gentler prices, own high streets, on the bus network

Renting works the same way across Australia: you apply through an agent, pay a bond of about four weeks' rent, which is lodged with the state's Rental Deposit Authority, and sign a lease. One Hobart habit worth copying: arrive with references, proof of income and your offer letter as clean PDFs, because good homes go to complete applications quickly. Most people rent for the first months and re-choose their suburb once they know the city.



A colonial cottage in Battery Point, Hobart's oldest village



Colour and character: an inner-Hobart facade

Before you sign a lease

- ☐ How is it heated? A heat pump makes winter cosy; this is the question in Hobart.
- ☐ Is it inside the school intake area you need? Boundaries run street by street.
- ☐ What's the commute at your shift times, including the bridge if you're on the eastern shore?
- ☐ Would a short-term rental first be wiser while you get to know the suburbs?



A historic park in central Hobart, close to the inner villages

Getting around Hobart

Hobart is a driving city with some of the shortest commutes in the country. Buses cover the main corridors, one bridge links the two shores, and a small car ferry takes you to Bruny Island.

GREENCARD

Metro buses

A bus network on the tap-on Greencard, handy along the main corridors and for the commute if you live on one; services are lighter in the evenings and at weekends.

EASTERN SHORE

The Tasman Bridge

The quick link between the eastern shore and the city. Worth checking at your actual shift times.

ALONG THE DERWENT

The intercity cycleway

A flat, off-road path along the river to the northern suburbs: one of the loveliest commutes going.

FROM KETTERING

The Bruny ferry

A small car ferry about 30 minutes south of the city links Hobart to Bruny Island.

Car-free life is realistic in the inner villages and along the bus corridors if you choose your street carefully. Everywhere else, plan on a car from day one. Australians drive on the left, and Hobart is a gentle place to learn: light traffic, short distances, and scenery that turns errands into small outings. You can usually drive on a valid overseas licence for a period, then convert to a Tasmanian licence once you're resident.

Two local skills: slow down and brake gently on frosty winter mornings, especially on the mountain road, and take extra care at dawn and dusk on the edges of town, when wildlife is on the move.

FROM THE CITY TO...	ROUGHLY	HOW
Sandy Bay or North Hobart	5–10 min	Drive, bus or cycle
The eastern shore (Bellerive)	~10 min	Drive or bus, via the bridge
Glenorchy	15–20 min	Drive, bus or the cycleway
Hobart Airport	~20 min	Drive or airport bus
Kingston	~20 min	Drive or bus

FROM THE CITY TO...	ROUGHLY	HOW
The Huon Valley	30–45 min	Drive
Bruny Island (via Kettering)	~45 min + ferry	Drive, then the car ferry
Launceston	~2 hr 30	Drive
Melbourne	~75 min	Flight from Hobart Airport



The Tasman Bridge, linking the eastern shore with the city



Central Hobart: compact, historic and easy to get around

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Bringing your car across

The Spirit of Tasmania car ferry sails across Bass Strait between Geelong, near Melbourne, and Devonport on Tasmania's north-west coast. It carries your car, your belongings and the family dog, and for many households it is the move itself. Devonport is about three hours' drive from Hobart, so build that into arrival day and book early in summer.

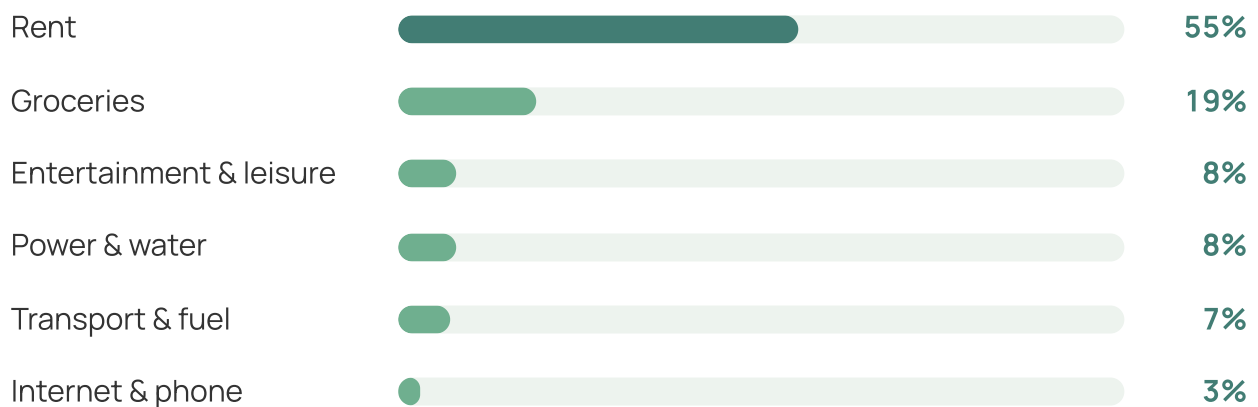
What it costs to live here

Hobart costs less than the big mainland capitals, and everyday life is gentle on the wallet. Housing is where the gap shows most, and it is housing that decides whether a salary feels generous.

We don't print prices in these guides, because a figure that was true when a page was written can mislead a year later. What stays true is the shape of a month and the lines worth planning for. Like-for-like housing runs well below Sydney and Melbourne, short commutes save time and fuel, and some of the best things to do here, from the mountain to the beaches, are free.

Two lines are worth planning for: **heating**, because winter is cool and much of the housing is older, and **a car**, because most households need one. On the income side, public health roles can salary-package part of your pay before tax, so ask payroll about it on day one.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is the biggest line, and a smaller share than in the big mainland capitals.

Worth planning for

- ✓ Winter heating. A home with a good heat pump can make a real difference to the season's bills, so make heating a search criterion.
- ✓ Island living. Goods cross Bass Strait, so some groceries, fuel and trades run a little dearer, and family visits mean a flight or the ferry.
- ✓ A reliable car, with registration and insurance, belongs in your arrival budget.
- ✓ The bridge to your first pay: temporary accommodation, a rental bond of about four weeks' rent, the car and some proper winter kit.



Riverside parks and gardens: some of Hobart's best things cost nothing



Sandstone squares and cafés in Hobart's historic waterfront precinct

IN SHORT

- ✓ On a clinical salary, Hobart is comfortable, and housing costs noticeably less than in Sydney or Melbourne.
- ✓ Choose a warm home with good heating; it pays you back every winter.
- ✓ Budget for a car early, and use the live calculators in the directory to compare Hobart with home.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Hobart

What I love about Hobart is how deliberately people make time for life: a walk up kunanyi after work, the market on a Saturday morning, a weekend somewhere wild. And in a smaller, close-knit system, you're valued and looked after in a way that bigger cities can find hard to match.

My advice is to choose Hobart on purpose. The clinicians who come for the life it really offers, crisp winters and all, become some of the happiest people I've ever placed. If you love seasons, nature and being part of a community, I'd love to help you take a closer look.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Friends round the table: community comes quickly in a smaller city



Making time for life: the reason so many people choose to move

Food, shopping and everyday life

Tasmania grows what the mainland's best restaurants serve, from seafood and cheese to berries and whisky, and in Hobart much of it is sold a few kilometres from where it was made.

SATURDAYS

Salamanca Market

Fills the sandstone waterfront every Saturday: part produce market, part makers' fair, part social occasion where you'll meet half your colleagues.

SUNDAYS · BATHURST STREET

Farm Gate Market

The cooks' market: growers, bakers and producers in the city centre every Sunday morning.

EVERYDAY

The weekly shop

Woolworths, Coles and ALDI across the city, plus Hill Street Grocer, the much-loved Tasmanian local chain.

WATERFRONT · NORTH HOBART

Eating out

Seafood around Constitution Dock, North Hobart's restaurant strip, and a bar scene that punches well above the city's size.

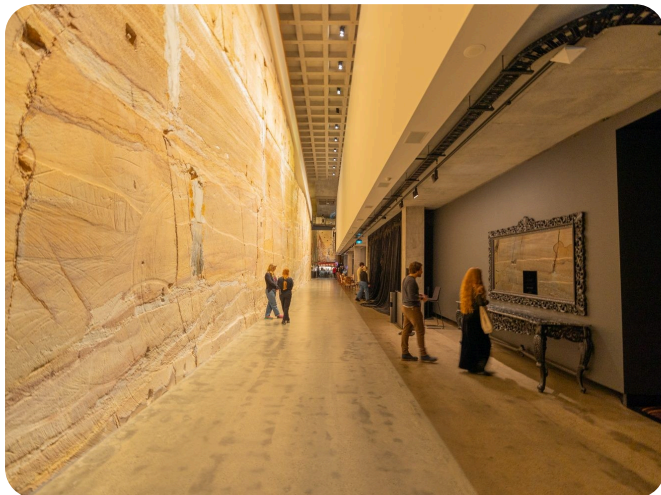


Cheese, wine and local produce: Tasmania's food is a big part of everyday life

Buying at the farm gate is a local habit: cherries in January, apples in autumn, oysters all year. The scallop pie, curried scallops in pastry, is the island's bakery signature and worth trying at least once, and Tasmanian

single malts win international awards.

Hobart has a friendly spread of Asian, Indian and continental grocers and some halal butchers, and the big supermarkets carry a growing world-food range. For harder-to-find ingredients, many families combine local shops with an online order. The Migrant Resource Centre Tasmania is a lovely first stop for finding your community's grocers, cooks and gatherings.



Inside MONA, the Museum of Old and New Art, reached by ferry up the Derwent



Flavours of home: Diwali, Onam and community feasts are part of Hobart's calendar

The rhythm of the year

- ✓ Summer: the Sydney to Hobart yachts arrive between Christmas and New Year, and the Taste of Summer fills the waterfront.
- ✓ All year: MONA itself, which changed how the rest of Australia sees Hobart.
- ✓ Winter: MONA's midwinter festival, Dark Mofo, brings fire, art and feasting to June. Hobart doesn't endure the dark; it throws it a party.
- ✓ Community celebrations such as Diwali, Onam and Harmony Week bring the city's growing communities together.

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Good to know

Single-use plastic bags aren't used in shops here, so locals keep reusable bags and a cooler bag in the car for the market run. For a big shopping trip or a touring concert, Melbourne is a short flight away.

What people do at the weekend

Almost everything worth a weekend sits within an hour or two of the wards, and in Hobart the seasons shape the calendar.

A typical Hobart weekend

- ✓ Saturday morning at Salamanca Market, coffee in hand, then a walk along the waterfront.
- ✓ MONA by ferry, then a long lunch back at the wharf.
- ✓ A cellar-door lunch in the Coal River Valley, about half an hour out.
- ✓ A drive to kunanyi's summit, then down the Organ Pipes or one of the foothill tracks.
- ✓ Kingston Beach at golden hour, or a picnic in the riverside parks.

~15 MIN

kunanyi / Mount Wellington

Summit views over the whole city, and tracks through fern gullies and alpine boulder fields on the way down.

~20 MIN

Kingston Beach

A gentle family beach with cafés and a playground, south of the city.

~30 MIN

Coal River Valley

Vineyards and cellar doors around historic Richmond, with its old sandstone bridge.

~45 MIN + FERRY

Bruny Island

Oysters, cheese and sea cliffs, and the narrow Neck at dusk.

~1 HR

Mount Field

Russell Falls and the tall-tree forests, out through World Heritage country.

~1 HR 30

The Tasman Peninsula

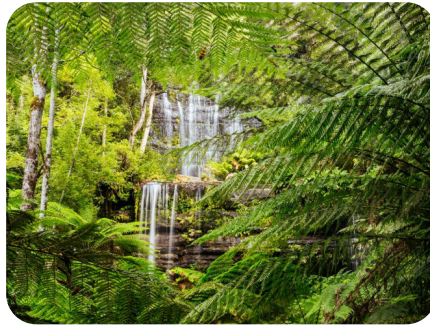
The Three Capes sea cliffs and Port Arthur's moving history.



**Hobart doesn't wait out the seasons.
It uses them: snow on the mountain in
July, long light on the beaches in January.**



From the summit of kunanyi: the whole city and estuary spread below



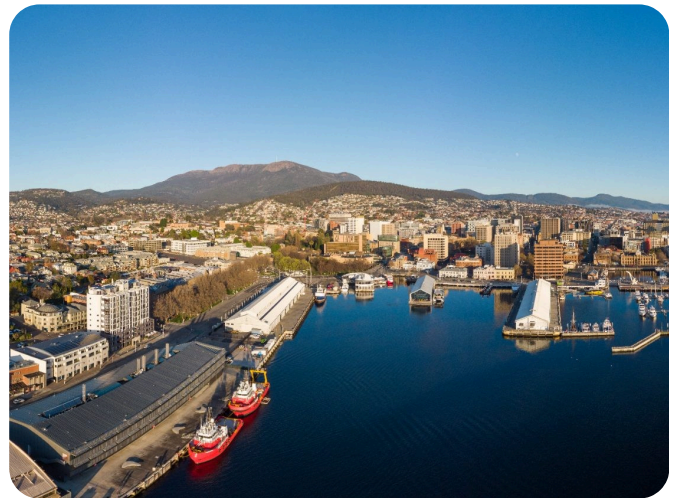
Russell Falls in Mount Field National Park, about an hour away



Hobart from the air: the harbour, the city and the mountain, all close together



Constitution Dock: fish and chips on the water is a classic Hobart weekend



Ferries leave from these wharves for MONA and trips down the Derwent

Day trips and weekends around Hobart

Tasmania is roughly the size of Ireland, and almost nothing on the island is more than a few hours away. From Hobart, beaches, wilderness, wine country and the second city are all easy trips.

Close to home, **Bruny Island** is a short drive and a car ferry from Kettering: oysters, cheese, sea cliffs and the famous Neck lookout. The **Tasman Peninsula** is about ninety minutes away, with the Three Capes walk along some of the highest sea cliffs in Australia and Port Arthur, a moving and important historic site. The **Huon Valley** is orchard and river country, and **Mount Field** National Park, an hour inland, has waterfalls, tall forests and a small club ski field.

Further afield, the east coast is a long weekend of pink granite and white sand at **Freycinet** and Wineglass Bay. **Launceston**, the island's elegant second city, is about two and a half hours north, with the Cataract Gorge in the middle of town and the Tamar Valley vineyards around it, and **Cradle Mountain** sits in the heart of the World Heritage wilderness.



Wineglass Bay, Freycinet National Park: a favourite long weekend from Hobart

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Long Beach, Sandy Bay & Kingston Beach	10–20 min	The nearest beaches: calm family swimming, cafés and golden-hour walks.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Hobart Airport	~20 min	Direct flights to Melbourne (about 75 minutes), Sydney, Brisbane and beyond.
Bruny Island	~45 min + ferry	Oysters, cheese, sea cliffs and wildlife; a classic day trip.
Mount Field National Park	~1 hr	Russell Falls and tall forests; the small Mount Mawson club ski field sits higher up in a snowy winter.
Port Arthur & the Tasman Peninsula	~1 hr 30	Towering sea cliffs, the Three Capes and essential history.
Ben Lomond (skiing)	~3 hrs	Tasmania's main ski field, near Launceston, in a good snow season; for bigger resorts, the Victorian Alps are a short flight away.
Launceston	~2 hr 30	The nearest other city: heritage streets, Cataract Gorge and Tamar Valley wine.
Freycinet & Wineglass Bay	~2 hr 30–3 hrs	Pink granite, white sand and turquoise water: a long weekend.

~45 MIN + FERRY

Bruny Island

Taste your way round the island, then watch for little penguins at the Neck at dusk in season.

30–45 MIN

The Huon Valley

Orchards, cider, river towns and roadside stalls; lovely in apple season.

~4 HRS

Cradle Mountain

Jagged peaks over Dove Lake and wombats by the boardwalks: a highlight of any year here.

~2 HR 30

Launceston & the Tamar

A gorge in the middle of town and cellar doors twenty minutes out.



White sand and clear water on the Tasmanian coast



Cradle Mountain and Dove Lake, in the island's World Heritage wilderness



Launceston, the island's second city, about two and a half hours north



Tasmania's east coast, a long weekend away



Honeymoon Bay in Freycinet National Park



Autumn in a Tasmanian vineyard: cellar doors are an easy weekend



Vineyards and cellar doors make a relaxed day out



Weekends by the sea, wherever the swell is running

A good place to grow up

Hobart is a lovely city for children: short commutes, beaches and bush close by, a strong sporting culture and a pace that leaves room for family time.



After the bell: the school day ends mid-afternoon, leaving time for sport and the beach



Water, bush and beaches make childhood very outdoors here

Tasmanian schooling runs in stages. Children start **Kindergarten**, a free government programme of part-time sessions, in the year before Prep, then move to **primary school** from Prep to Year 6 and **high school** from Year 7 to Year 10. Years 11 and 12 are usually completed at a **senior secondary college** or an extended high school, a distinctive Tasmanian model that gives older students a more adult, college-style setting. Young people stay in education or training until they turn 18 or complete Year 12 or an equivalent.

Most children attend government schools, which take enrolments by **intake area**, so check the area for an exact address before you sign a lease. Catholic schools (run through Catholic Education Tasmania) and independent schools are well established, including long-standing Hobart schools such as The Hutchins School, Fahan School, St Michael's Collegiate and The Friends' School.

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School fees for temporary visa holders

Tasmania enrolls the children of temporary visa holders in government schools through its Temporary Resident Program. Dependents of subclass 482 visa holders pay no tuition, just the ordinary school levies that every family pays; some other visa subclasses pay a portion of the programme fee. Check your visa subclass on the Department for Education, Children and Young People's Temporary Resident Program page before you budget.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the intake area for the exact address on the Department for Education, Children and Young People's Find your local school page.
- ☐ Ask about the school levy and how uniforms are bought: most schools have their own uniform shop or nominated supplier, and many run second-hand sales.
- ☐ Visit, or ask for a call with the principal; schools are used to welcoming families from overseas.
- ☐ For Years 11 and 12, look at the senior secondary colleges and what courses they offer.

What children tend to love here

- ✓ Beaches at Kingston, Blackmans Bay and Sandy Bay, with surf lifesaving Nippers in summer.
- ✓ Salamanca Market, the waterfront and the ferries up the Derwent.
- ✓ Bush walks, waterfalls and wildlife spotting at weekends.
- ✓ Snow on kunanyi in winter, often just a short drive from home.
- ✓ Club sport for every age: Aussie Rules, cricket, netball, football, sailing and more.



Early learning here is very hands-on and outdoors



Senior school: clear pathways to university and vocational training

i

Early childhood

Long day care and family day care are available across the city, and the national Child Care Subsidy can help with costs for eligible families. Free government Kindergarten in the year before Prep is a gentle start to school life.

HOBART CAMPUSES

University of Tasmania

The state's university, with its medical school, nursing and allied health teaching, and a campus at Sandy Bay alongside a growing presence in the city centre.

VOCATIONAL TRAINING

TasTAFE

Practical courses statewide, including health and community services, and free English classes for eligible new migrants.



Early learning is play-based and full of energy



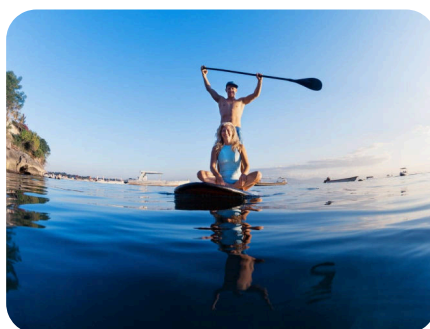
Creative, hands-on learning from the early years



Family healthcare close to home



Surf lessons and Nippers are a summer favourite for children



Calm-water days on the paddleboard



A koala in the gum trees



Hobart suits clinicians who choose it on purpose, and rewards them with a life that fits.

Your Hobart address book

Hobart is a small city with a growing and welcoming mix of communities. Indian, Malayali, Punjabi, Sri Lankan, Nepali, Filipino and African communities hold festivals through the year, from Onam and Diwali to Sri Lankan New Year, and the Migrant Resource Centre Tasmania is the best first stop for finding your people.

COUNCILS & LOCAL SERVICES

City of Hobart

The inner city and suburbs: bins, parking, libraries, parks, kunanyi tracks and events

hobartcity.com.au

City of Clarence

The eastern shore, including Bellerive, Lindisfarne and Rosny

03 6217 9500 ccc.tas.gov.au

Kingborough Council

Kingston, Blackmans Bay and Bruny Island

kingborough.tas.gov.au

Glenorchy City Council

Glenorchy and the northern suburbs

03 6216 6800 gcc.tas.gov.au

Metro Tasmania

Hobart buses, Greencard, timetables and journey planning

metrotas.com.au

Transport Tasmania

Driver licences, overseas licence conversion and vehicle registration

transport.tas.gov.au

healthdirect

Free 24-hour health advice line from a registered nurse

1800 022 222 healthdirect.gov.au

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Migrant Resource Centre Tasmania

Settlement support, English and driving programmes, employment help, youth services and community connections. Based in Glenorchy.

03 6221 0999 mrctas.org.au

Multicultural Council of Tasmania

The state's peak body for multicultural communities, with member community groups across the island; runs events including Harmony Week.

Malayalee Association of Tasmania

The Kerala community association in Hobart; holds an annual Onam celebration in North Hobart.

Indian Cultural Society of Tasmania

Brings the South Asian community in Hobart together for Diwali, Indian Independence Day, dance, music and food. Based in Glenorchy.

Punjabi Society Tasmania

Punjabi community association; hosts Diwali and cultural celebrations.

Hobart SL Lions Sports Club

Sri Lankan community club: Sri Lankan New Year festival, Christmas gatherings and cricket.

hobartslionssportsclub.com.au

Tamil Arts & Cultural Society of Tasmania

Tamil cultural celebrations, including Tamil New Year.

Nigerian Tasmanian Community

Celebrates Nigerian culture, food and music and connects Nigerian and wider African families across Tasmania.

Adult Migrant English Program (TasTAFE)

Free English classes for eligible new migrants in southern Tasmania.

1300 655 307 tastafe.tas.edu.au

Libraries Tasmania

Free library membership, children's story times and adult literacy and learning programmes.

libraries.tas.gov.au

FACEBOOK GROUPS

Indian Cultural Society of Tasmania

Facebook group for event dates and community notices.

facebook.com/groups/20518995699

Nigerian Tasmanian Community

Facebook page for news and events.

facebook.com/people/Nigerian-Tasmanian-Community/100066605205162

Hindu Temple, Bridgewater

Facebook group for the temple's festivals and pujas.

facebook.com/groups/176635479075658

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St Mary's Cathedral (Catholic)

The city's Catholic cathedral, Harrington Street; Saturday vigil and Sunday Masses.

stmaryscathedralhobart.org.au

St Thomas Syro-Malabar Mission, Hobart

Syro-Malabar Catholic mission for Kerala families; contact the eparchy office for Qurbana dates and venue.

syromalabar.org.au/hobart

St David's Cathedral (Anglican)

Anglican cathedral at 23 Murray Street in the city centre.

saintdavids.org.au

C3 Church Hobart (Pentecostal)

Contemporary Pentecostal church in Hobart.

c3hobart.org.au

Holy Trinity Greek Orthodox Church

Greek Orthodox parish serving Hobart's Greek community.

Hobart Mosque

Tasmania's first purpose-built mosque, in West Hobart; Friday prayers and community events.

BAPS Shri Swaminarayan Mandir, Claremont

Hindu mandir in Hobart's northern suburbs.

baps.org

Hindu Temple, Bridgewater

Hindu temple in the northern suburbs; festival news via its Facebook group.

Gurdwara Nanak Darbar, Cambridge

Sikh gurdwara on the eastern side of the city.

Wat Sanggharangsee (Buddhist)

Thai Theravada Buddhist temple, 14 Conrad Drive, Otago; meditation and observance days.

watsanggharangsee.org

Hobart Buddhist Meditation Centre

Weekly meditation sessions and Buddhist teachings.

tashicholing.net

Hobart Synagogue

Australia's oldest synagogue (1845), 59 Argyle Street; home of the Hobart Hebrew Congregation, which can also advise on kosher food.

hobartsynagogue.org

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Tasmanian Meats Wholesalers

Butcher at 169 Campbell Street, listed in Hobart halal guides; ask about halal lines.

tasmeats.com.au

Vermeys Quality Meats

Butcher at 180 Sandy Bay Road, listed in Hobart halal guides; ask about halal lines.

vermeys.com.au

Coles and Woolworths

Select halal meat products and growing world-food aisles; range varies by store.

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Woolworths

Full-range supermarkets across Greater Hobart.

[woolworths.com.au](https://www.woolworths.com.au)

Coles

Full-range supermarkets across Greater Hobart.

[coles.com.au](https://www.coles.com.au)

ALDI

Discount supermarkets in Hobart's suburbs.

[aldi.com.au](https://www.aldi.com.au)

Hill Street Grocer

Much-loved Tasmanian grocer with stores in West Hobart, South Hobart, Sandy Bay, New Town, Blackmans Bay and more.

[hillstreetgrocer.com](https://www.hillstreetgrocer.com)

Salamanca Market

Every Saturday, 8.30am to 3pm, on Salamanca Place: produce, makers and street food.

[salamancamarket.com.au](https://www.salamancamarket.com.au)

Farm Gate Market

Every Sunday morning on Bathurst Street in the city: growers and producers.

[farmgatemarket.com.au](https://www.farmgatemarket.com.au)

SCHOOLS & UNIFORMS

Find your local school (DECYP)

Check which government school's intake area covers an address.

decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Temporary Resident Program

School enrolment and fees for children of temporary visa holders; check your visa subclass.

study.tas.gov.au/trp

Catholic Education Tasmania

Catholic schools and colleges across the state.

[catholic.tas.edu.au](https://www.catholic.tas.edu.au)

School uniforms

Bought through each school's own uniform shop or nominated supplier; many schools also run second-hand uniform sales. Ask the school office when you enrol.

HOUSING & AREAS

realestate.com.au

Rental and sale listings across Hobart.

[realestate.com.au](https://www.realestate.com.au)

Domain

Rental and sale listings.

[domain.com.au](https://www.domain.com.au)

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and shared houses, useful for a first few months.

[flatmates.com.au](https://www.flatmates.com.au)

Rental Deposit Authority (CBOS)

Where rental bonds are lodged in Tasmania; also renting rights and guides.

cbos.tas.gov.au

Tenants' Union of Tasmania

Free legal advice for renters.

1300 652 641 [tutas.org.au](https://www.tutas.org.au)

GETTING AROUND

Metro Tasmania

Hobart buses, the Greencard, timetables and journey planning.

[metrotas.com.au](https://www.metrotas.com.au)

Transport Tasmania

Converting an overseas driver licence, registration and road rules.

[transport.tas.gov.au](https://www.transport.tas.gov.au)

Spirit of Tasmania

Car and passenger ferry between Geelong and Devonport.

[spiritoftasmania.com.au](https://www.spiritoftasmania.com.au)

COST COMPARISON LINKS

Numbeo – Hobart

Crowd-sourced prices to compare with your current city.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Hobart

Expatistan – Hobart

A second crowd-sourced comparison, side by side.

expatistan.com/cost-of-living/hobart

Australian Bureau of Statistics

Official figures on prices and inflation.

abs.gov.au



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
mara.gov.au

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 ahpra.gov.au

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

MONEY & HOME

Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

SETTLING IN

TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.

— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Hobart. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



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